

Becoming a coder

Coders are the people who write the programs behind everything we see and do on a computer. You can create your own programs by learning a programming language.

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Scratch?

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Python?

Programming languages

There are a huge range of programming languages to choose from. Each one can be used for different tasks. Here are some of the most popular languages and what they are often used for:

C A powerful language for building computer operating systems.

Ada Used to control spacecraft, satellites, and airplanes.

Java Works on computers, cell phones, and tablets.

MATLAB Ideal for programs that need to carry out lots of calculations.

Ruby Automatically turns lots of information into web pages.

Javascript A language used to build interactive websites.

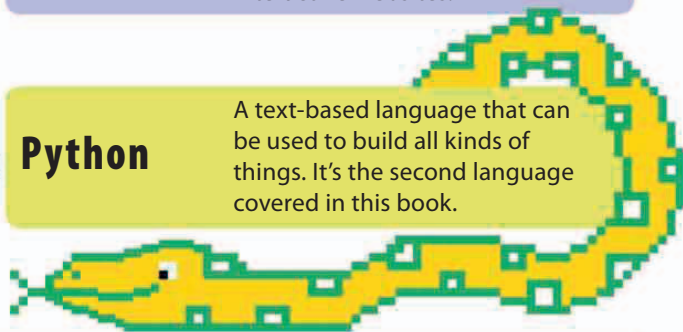
Scratch

A visual language that's ideal for learning programming. This is the first language covered in this book.



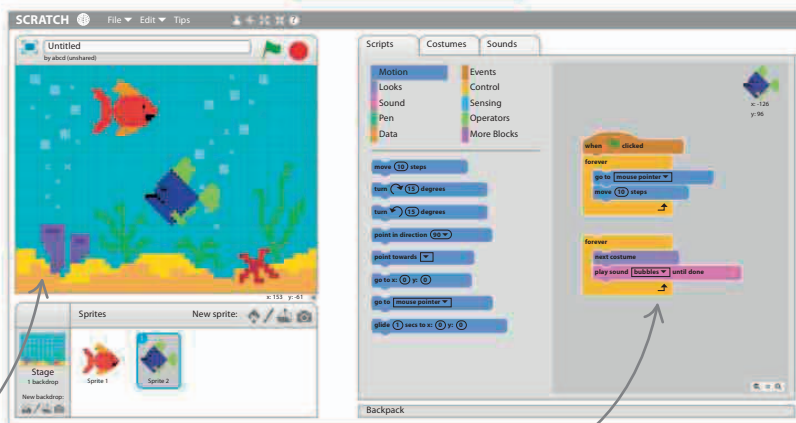
Python

A text-based language that can be used to build all kinds of things. It's the second language covered in this book.



What is Scratch?

Scratch is a great way to start coding. Programs are created by connecting together blocks of code, instead of typing it out. Scratch is quick and easy to use, and also teaches you the key ideas you need to use other programming languages.



The program appears on this side of the screen

Code is made by connecting colored blocks together